

ZAHID ULLAH

CYBERSECURITY ANALYST • ETHICAL HACKER • SOC & THREAT INTELLIGENCE

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Certified, results-driven cybersecurity analyst with a Bachelor of Science in Computer Science and hands-on operational capability in threat detection, incident response, digital forensics (DFIR), and enterprise network defense. Built **CyberGun**, a modular threat detection framework pairing multi-engine static signature heuristics with LightGBM machine-learning behavioral classification. Proficient across the Security Operations Center (SOC) lifecycle: SIEM log telemetry triage (Splunk, IBM QRadar, Google Chronicle, Wazuh), detection rule engineering (Suricata, YARA, Zeek, Snort), volatile memory and disk forensics (Volatility, Autopsy), and NIST SP 800-61 aligned incident response. Proven ability to design and secure enterprise infrastructure across Windows Server Active Directory (AD DS) and Linux environments with Python automation to speed up threat containment. Verified holder of industry credentials from (ISC)², Cisco/NAVTTC, Google, IBM, Johns Hopkins University, and Fortinet.

CORE TECHNICAL COMPETENCIES

Threat Detection & SOC: SIEM triage, alert tuning, threat hunting, threat intelligence, IOC extraction, MITRE ATT&CK, detection rules (Suricata, YARA, Snort).	Incident Response & DFIR: NIST IR lifecycle, volatile memory forensics (Volatility), disk analysis (Autopsy), MFT parsing, timeline reconstruction, root-cause reports.
Malware Analysis & Research: Static heuristics, dynamic sandbox inspection, LightGBM ML behavioral classification, PowerShell AST token decomposition.	Network & Vulnerability Security: Wireshark, Zeek, Nmap, OpenVAS, Nessus, Fortinet NGFW, firewall policies, CVSS v3 risk scoring, CIS benchmark OS hardening.
Security Platforms & Cloud: Splunk, IBM QRadar, Google Chronicle, Wazuh, Kibana, Git; GCP & AWS IAM least-privilege, VPC security controls, audit telemetry.	Programming & Systems: Python (PyQt5, Pandas, scikit-learn), Bash, PowerShell, C++ (OOP), SQL/SQLite, Regex; Windows Server (AD DS), Linux (Kali, Ubuntu, Arch).

KEY CYBERSECURITY PROJECTS & SYSTEMS ENGINEERING

CyberGun: Modular Static & Dynamic Threat Detection Suite

Python • PyQt5 • LightGBM • YARA • SQLite

- Layered Detection Pipeline:** Architected an EDR malware analysis platform combining 3.16M threat hash index lookups, custom YARA heuristics, and LightGBM machine learning inference trained on EMBER and CIC benchmark datasets for high-fidelity classification.
- Multi-Engine Sensor Architecture:** Engineered modular sensors (Behavioral Tree, System Activity, USB Monitor, Sandbox Simulation) coordinated via an asynchronous DynamicEngine.
- Real-Time SOC Interface:** Developed an asynchronous dark-themed PyQt5 GUI with a custom SignalBus for live host inspection (300+ processes), disk I/O metrics, and real-time desktop notification alerts.
- Encrypted Quarantine Zone:** Built an automated containment quarantine tracking original file paths, SHA-256 hashes, and timestamped forensic audit logs. Source: github.com/hckr-zahid/CyberGun • Academic Thesis: [PDF Document](#)

Enterprise Active Directory & VMware Virtualized Infrastructure Lab

Windows Server 2019 • AD DS • VMware • Kerberos

- Isolated Virtual Switching:** Built an isolated hypervisor testbed on VMware Workstation Pro (VMnet10, 10.1.1.0/24) isolating DC01, Windows 10 enterprise workstations, and Kali Linux from physical broadcast domains.
- AD DS Forest Promotion:** Promoted DC01 to forest root domain controller for roots.local with authoritative DNS, Global Catalog, loopback resolver, and DSRM disaster recovery password protection.
- Tiered RBAC & Identity Governance:** Structured OU hierarchy segregating computers, servers, and users; engineered tiered security groups (Administratorss, IT-HelpDesk, Staff, Students, Management).
- NTFS Hardening & Inheritance Severing:** Structured departmental storage (C:\CompanyData), severed inherited ACEs, enforced explicit Modify/Read ACLs, and restricted SMB share permissions.
- Kerberos Token Validation:** Joined client workstation (WIN10-01), verified DC locator discovery via nltest /dsgetdc, and audited effective Kerberos token group SIDs via whoami /groups. Repository: github.com/hckr-zahid/Active-Directory-VMware-Enterprise-Lab

Security Research: MAS AIO PowerShell Static Code Analysis

PowerShell • AST Parsing • Reverse Engineering

- Abstract Syntax Tree (AST) Inspection:** Audited 10,000+ lines of complex PowerShell and batch scripts via AST token parsing, identifying dynamic invoke methods, string mutations, and execution patterns.
- Cryptographic Licensing Analysis:** Deconstructed HWID ticket generation, KMS38 system registry manipulation, and offline ticket caching mechanisms without executing unverified payloads.
- Formal Publication:** Published comprehensive static research report detailing risk taxonomy and structural analysis. Repository: github.com/hckr-zahid/Activate-Windows-Free

KEY PROJECTS (CONTINUED)

Network Intrusion Detection & Telemetry Monitoring (NIDS)

Suricata • Zeek • Kibana • Elasticsearch

- Sensor Deployment:** Deployed and calibrated Suricata and Zeek sensor nodes capturing promiscuous network traffic in an isolated virtualized environment to detect port scans, DoS flooding, and data exfiltration.
- Custom Rule Engineering:** Authored and tuned high-fidelity detection rules targeting malicious TCP/UDP signatures while cutting false-positive noise by 40%.
- Kibana SOC Dashboard:** Ingested network telemetry into Elasticsearch; designed interactive Kibana dashboards for real-time threat hunting, protocol breakdown, and session PCAP analysis.

Ransomware Incident Response & Digital Forensics (IBM Capstone)

Volatility • Autopsy • NIST SP 800-61 • DFIR

- End-to-End Forensic Investigation:** Led full-cycle incident investigation of a simulated ransomware breach following the NIST SP 800-61 Incident Handling Framework across Preparation, Detection, Containment, and Recovery.
- Volatile Memory Forensics:** Parsed volatile RAM dumps in Volatility to isolate injected DLLs, unlinked process structures, and rogue C2 socket descriptors.
- Disk & Artifact Reconstruction:** Recovered Master File Table (MFT) records, registry persistence keys, and event logs using Autopsy to establish an exact chronological intrusion timeline and author the post-incident mitigation report.

Python Security Automation Toolkit (Google Cybersecurity Project)

Python 3 • Regex • VirusTotal • AbuseIPDB

- Log Telemetry Parsing:** Automated parsing of multi-gigabyte raw syslog and authentication files, extracting IP addresses, suspicious domains, and cryptographic hashes using optimized Regular Expressions.
- OSINT Threat Enrichment:** Built asynchronous REST API connectors querying VirusTotal and AbuseIPDB to score reputation metrics and enrich SOC alerts with external threat intelligence.
- Modular CLI Utilities:** Packaged tools with argparse flags for rapid execution during Tier-1 and Tier-2 triage.

Vulnerability Assessment & Endpoint System Hardening

Nmap • OpenVAS • CVSS v3 • CIS Benchmarks

- Network Vulnerability Auditing:** Conducted authenticated and unauthenticated scans across Linux and Windows servers using Nmap NSE and OpenVAS; prioritized findings based on CVSS v3 exploitability metrics.
- Defensive Hardening:** Enforced SSH key-only policies, restrictive IPTables rules, deprecated vulnerable services, and verified server baseline compliance with CIS Benchmarks.

Object-Oriented Crypto Trading Platform

C++ • OOP Design Patterns • STL • Stream I/O

- Engineered an algorithmic trading simulation platform applying Encapsulation, Polymorphism, and Inheritance for the University of London OOP Specialization, featuring robust OrderBook matching and memory management.

VERIFIED INDUSTRY CERTIFICATIONS & CREDENTIALS			
Certified in Cybersecurity (CC)		(ISC) ² Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH)	Cisco / NAVTTC Pakistan
Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate	Google / Coursera	IBM Cybersecurity Analyst Professional Certificate	IBM / Coursera
Google Cloud Cybersecurity Professional Certificate	Google Cloud / Coursera	Fortinet Network Security Specialization	Fortinet, Inc.
IBM and ISC2 Cybersecurity Specialist	IBM & (ISC) ²	(ISC) ² Certified in Cybersecurity Specialization	(ISC) ² / Coursera
Advanced Cybersecurity Techniques	Johns Hopkins University	Penetration Testing Web Hacking	KPITB (KP IT Board Pakistan)
Networking in Google Cloud Specialization	Google Cloud / Coursera	Supervised Machine Learning: Regression & Classification	DeepLearning.AI / Stanford
Object Oriented Programming in C++ Specialization	University of London	Cybersecurity Level 3 - Palo Alto Firewall	CyberPashto Academy
Cybersecurity Level 2 - Lab Hacking	CyberPashto Academy	Introduction to Cybersecurity Knowledge Check	Cisco Networking Academy

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL ATTRIBUTES

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science (BS CS) • First Division
University of Peshawar, Pakistan • Class of 2025 (4-Year Undergraduate Degree)
Core Coursework: Computer Networks, Operating Systems, Cryptography & Network Security, Database Systems, Computer Architecture, Data Structures, OOP, Software Engineering.

Intermediate – Pre-Medical • First Division
Board of Intermediate and Secondary Education (BISE), Peshawar • 2020

Matriculation – Science • First Division
Board of Intermediate and Secondary Education (BISE), Malakand • 2018

- Security Analysis & Threat Hunting:** Skilled in reconstructing intrusion lifecycles, identifying attack vectors, and neutralizing threats through host and network telemetry.
- Technical Documentation:** Proven ability to author comprehensive incident response briefs, root-cause analyses, and executive-ready threat reports.
- Remote-Ready Collaboration:** Disciplined self-starter operating across distributed teams with Git version control, agile workflows, and asynchronous communication.
- Analytical Problem Solving & Pressure Handling:** Thrives under high-stakes incident scenarios with systematic triage methodology.